Mingda Li

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Work Experience

Staff Machine Learning Software Engineer / Tech Lead 11-2022 – Present
Uber, Inc. *New York City, NY (Hybrid)*

- **Spearheaded LLM-based embeddings** across **9 use cases**, driving **$243M+** annualized GB while cutting infrastructure costs by **93%**.
- **Led 3 personalized shopping ML initiatives**: engineered Pre-checkout Bundling (**$150M+ GB**), deployed Auto-generated Carousels (**$33M GB**), and built a **RAG** framework boosting taxonomy accuracy from **86% to 93%** across 9 markets.

Senior Machine Learning Software Engineer 08-2020 – 11-2022
Pinterest, Inc. *San Francisco, CA (Remote)*

- **Overhauled relevance modeling** for Related Pins and Closeup streams, boosting core relevance metrics by **2x%**.
- **Engineered multi-head ranking labels**, driving a **3x%** product metric lift and **5%** engagement surge.
- **Optimized candidate retrieval & ranking** via a novel two-tower model and real-time user signals, lifting engagement by up to **5%**.

Research Scientist Intern 05-2019 – 08-2019
Facebook, Inc. *Seattle, WA*

- **Localized News Feed content understanding** by extending post classification pipelines and workflows to Spanish using **Hive SQL**.
- **Trained high-accuracy post classifiers** utilizing transfer learning, label filtering, and new feature workflows, achieving **AUCs above 97%–99%**.
- **Deployed production models and developer tooling**, delivering an inspection tool and a production **GraphQL API** authored in **Hack**.

Education

New Jersey Institute of Technology Ph.D. in CS, 09-2015 – 08-2020
University of Science and Technology of China M.S. in CS, 09-2012 – 06-2015
Harbin Institute of Technology B.S. in CS, 09-2008 – 07-2012

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, C/C++, Golang, Java, Scala, PHP/Hack, Hive SQL, Presto, GraphQL, HTML/CSS
Frameworks/Libraries: Hadoop, Spark, TensorFlow, Pytorch, Keras
Developer Tools: Git/Mercurial, Google Cloud/Amazon EC2/Microsoft Azure, VS Code, PyCharm, IntelliJ

Publications

- **Mingda Li**, William V Rapp, and Yi Chen. *Rethinking worrying about the stock market, but instead, anxious about employment.* Journal of Corporate Accounting & Finance, 2023.
- **Mingda Li**, Jinhe Shi, and Yi Chen. *Identifying Influences in Patient Decision-Making Processes in Online Health Communities.* Journal of Medical Internet Research **(JMIR)**, 2022.
- **Mingda Li**, Weiting Gao, and Yi Chen. *A Topic and Concept Integrated Model for Thread Recommendation in Online Health Communities.* The 29th ACM international Conference on Information and Knowledge Management **(CIKM)**, 2020.
- **Mingda Li**, Jinhe Shi, and Yi Chen. *Analyzing Patient Decision Making in Online Health Communities.* The 7th IEEE International Conference on Healthcare Informatics **(ICHI)**, 2019.
- Yi Shan, **Mingda Li**, and Yi Chen. *Constructing target-aware results for keyword search on knowledge graphs.* Data & Knowledge Engineering **(DKE)**, 2017.